DANIEL R. OKAFOR, CPA, CGFM

Senior Financial Management Executive | Budget, Audit & Resource Stewardship

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Federal financial management executive with 19 years of progressive leadership in budget formulation and execution, financial reporting, audit remediation, and payment integrity. Oversees execution of an $8.6B annual budget and leads a 140-person finance organization. Delivered the agency's first unmodified audit opinion in six years, eliminated Anti-Deficiency Act violations, and returned more than $170M to mission priorities through disciplined resource stewardship.

EXECUTIVE CORE QUALIFICATIONS (ECQS)

Commitment to the Rule of Law and the Principles of the American Founding

- Enforced appropriations law (purpose, time, amount) across an $8.6B portfolio; installed pre-obligation funds-control checks that cut Anti-Deficiency Act violations from 3 in FY2020 to zero for five consecutive years.
- Led the payment-integrity program under the Payment Integrity Information Act; improper payment rate fell from 6.1% to 2.4% and $38M was recovered for taxpayers.
- Prepared the Assistant Secretary for six appropriations hearings, ensuring testimony and budget justifications were accurate, transparent, and fully supported.

Driving Efficiency

- Directed a bureau-wide review of unobligated and expiring balances, recovering $112M and reprogramming it to priority missions with OMB and congressional approval.
- Consolidated four bureau accounting operations into one shared service center, cutting cost per transaction 27% and saving $9.4M per year.
- Deployed robotic process automation for Fund Balance with Treasury reconciliations, saving 22,000 staff-hours per year and shrinking the cycle from 15 days to 3.

Merit and Competence

- Remediated two long-standing material weaknesses (property and Fund Balance with Treasury) in two audit cycles, earning the agency's first unmodified opinion in six years.
- Traced $210M in unsupported undelivered orders to weak obligation documentation; built a data-driven validation process that deobligated $58M in stale funds.
- Stood up financial controls for a $1.3B emergency supplemental within 10 days, delivering complete and on-time DATA Act spending reports.

Leading People

- Lead 140 accountants, budget analysts, and auditors across five divisions through eight supervisors, each held to measurable accuracy and timeliness standards.
- Recruited 26 credentialed staff and sponsored CPA/CGFM certification; certified workforce grew from 18% to 41% and attrition fell from 16% to 8%.
- Addressed chronic performance gaps through improvement plans and reassignments, restoring on-time month-end close from 62% to 98%.

Achieving Results

- Translated the Secretary's cost-reduction directive into a three-year plan with bureau targets, achieving $64M in recurring savings (104% of goal).
- Introduced zero-based reviews for 38 programs, ending six low-performing programs and redirecting $47M to higher-return priorities.

TECHNICAL QUALIFICATIONS (TQS)

TQ 1: Expert knowledge of federal budget formulation, execution, and appropriations law

- Oversee execution of an $8.6B budget and previously managed funds control for $24B in accounts; zero Anti-Deficiency Act violations for five consecutive years.

TQ 2: Demonstrated leadership of financial reporting, internal controls, and audit remediation

- Led the agency to its first unmodified audit opinion in six years, cleared two material weaknesses, and chair the OMB A-123 Senior Assessment Team.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Deputy Chief Financial Officer **04/2021 – Present**
U.S. Department of the Interior, Office of Financial Management – Washington, DC
Financial Administration, GS-0501-15 | 40+ hours per week

- Principal deputy to the CFO for budget execution, financial reporting, internal controls (OMB A-123), and audit liaison with the Inspector General.
- Direct a $28M operating budget and five divisions; chair the Senior Assessment Team for internal control.

Director, Budget Execution and Funds Control **07/2016 – 04/2021**
U.S. Department of Agriculture, Office of the Chief Financial Officer – Washington, DC
Budget Analysis, GS-0560-15 | 40+ hours per week

- Managed apportionment, allotment, and funds control for $24B in discretionary and mandatory accounts; led a 35-person staff.
- Implemented a spend-plan dashboard that cut year-end lapsed funds 63%.

Audit Liaison Manager / Senior Accountant **05/2011 – 07/2016**
U.S. Department of the Treasury, Bureau of the Fiscal Service – Parkersburg, WV
Accounting, GS-0510-13/14 | 40+ hours per week

- Coordinated financial statement audits and corrective action plans; closed 41 audit findings ahead of schedule.

Senior Audit Associate **08/2007 – 05/2011**
Calder & Wynn LLP – Arlington, VA
Private sector | 50 hours per week

- Audited federal agency and contractor financial statements under GAGAS and OMB audit guidance.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration, Finance, Georgetown University – Washington, DC 2013
Bachelor of Science, Accounting, Virginia Tech – Blacksburg, VA 2007

CERTIFICATIONS, TRAINING & AWARDS

- Certified Public Accountant (Virginia); Certified Government Financial Manager (CGFM), AGA
- Executive Leadership Program, Federal Executive Institute (2021); Member, AGA and ASMC
- Secretary’s Award for Financial Excellence (2024); Certificate of Excellence in Accountability Reporting, agency team lead (FY2023)